The Supervision Spectrum: Where You Approve

Move right as the risk drops and your verify loop gets stronger; the review point moves later each step

	Ask before every action	Accept edits, ask for commands	Plan mode	Auto / autopilot
	you approve each edit and command	edits land; commands wait	read-only until the plan is approved	you review the result
Claude Code	Manual mode (config value: default)	acceptEdits (Shift+Tab from Manual)	plan (Shift+Tab, /plan, Ctrl+G to edit)	auto: a classifier reviews actions bypassPermissions: sandbox only
GitHub Copilot	Manual permissions; Confirm / Allow per tool	Edits apply (Keep / Undo); terminal auto-approve rules	Plan agent (VS, VS Code); CLI plan mode or /plan	Allow all; Autopilot mode; CLI autopilot, --allow-all-tools
Use it for	Unfamiliar code, production config, secrets nearby	Everyday work on a branch you can diff and reset	Multi-file features; anything you would design first	Well-tested code, strong verify loop, isolated environment

At every level: deny rules block, hooks enforce, and git diff plus your tests decide what you keep